

DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS - CLASS NOTES

Wednesday, 7 October 2026 | Complete English notes with Quick Revision & MCQs

Topics: Nobel Prize in Physics 2026 | West Bengal PSC questions | NSO Household Travel Survey | Static/Eco quiz | Three new Supreme Court judges | Al-Alamein Declaration (Red Sea) | Dibrugarh-Dhaka cargo vessel | N Kisan WASH social bond and SEBI Jagruk | India-Switzerland TEPA and gifts | Odisha MICE portal | National Wildlife Week | Harmanpreet Kaur steps down as captain.

1. NOBEL PRIZE IN PHYSICS 2026

- **Question:** Who won the Physics Nobel (for neutrino/astrophysics study)? **Answer: Francis Halzen** - the prize went to **one person** this time (not three).
- **Who:** **Belgian-American** physicist. **Work:** **astrophysics and neutrinos**; built the **IceCube Observatory** at the **South Pole (Antarctica)** to study neutrinos. The neutrino is called the '**Ghost Particle**'.
- **Awarded by:** **Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences** (Sweden); prize money **12 million krona** (same as every Nobel).
- **Recap - Medicine 2026** (yesterday): **Nagel, Deisseroth (spoken 'Desroth'), Hegemann** ('NDH' trick). **Physics 2025** (three winners, as spoken): **John Clarke, John Martinis, Michel Devoret** (named in class as 'John Carl', 'John Martis', 'Michael Jebroch'). Old-year winners can also be asked.
- Class advice: repeat the names 5-6 times instead of making tricks.

QUICK REVISION: Physics 2026: Francis Halzen (Belgian-American) | One winner | IceCube, South Pole | Neutrino = ghost particle | Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences | 12 million krona | Medicine 2026: Nagel, Deisseroth, Hegemann.

2. WEST BENGAL PSC QUESTIONS AND STATIC QUIZ

- **Asiatic Society of Bengal** (founded **1784**) - associated with **Warren Hastings** (answer given in class). **Tehri Dam** - on the **Bhagirathi, Uttarakhand**.
- **Cost-push inflation:** caused by an **increase in the cost/price of inputs** (option C). **Disguised unemployment:** more people work than needed, with no rise in output (e.g. 4 people on land where 2 produce the same). **Angle of contact** when liquid does not wet glass: **obtuse** (not acute).
- **SEBI:** Securities and Exchange Board of India - set up **1988**, statutory **1992**; HQ **Mumbai**; regulates **NSE and BSE**. **Vice President of India:** **C.P. Radhakrishnan**.
- **Non-fossil electricity milestone 2026:** answer not given in class (options 320/350 discussed); recall: **target 500 GW, 300+ GW** already achieved.

QUICK REVISION: Asiatic Society 1784 - Warren Hastings | Tehri - Bhagirathi | Cost-push = input cost rise | Angle of contact obtuse (non-wetting) | SEBI 1988/1992, Mumbai | VP: C.P. Radhakrishnan.

3. NSO - NATIONAL HOUSEHOLD TRAVEL SURVEY (FIRST TIME)

- **Question:** Which organisation released India's first National Household Travel Survey (July 2025 - June 2026)? **Answer: National Statistics Office (NSO)** under the **Ministry of Statistics (MoSPI)**. NSO also collects census-type data (2026-27 data being collected).
- **Basis:** five factors - **expenditure, purpose, mode, distance, duration**; covers urban and rural; about **20.34 lakh persons** (as spoken).
- **Findings (as stated):** **61.9% men** travel (mainly for jobs) vs **41.9% women**; **~37%** of students walk to school; **42.6%** use **two-wheelers**; monthly commuting cost **Rs. 785**; children under 6 walk about 1 km.
- **P.C. Mahalanobis = Father of Indian Statistics**; the **Second Five Year Plan** followed the Mahalanobis model.

QUICK REVISION: First National Household Travel Survey | NSO, MoSPI | Jul 2025-Jun 2026 | 5 factors | Men 61.9%, women 41.9% | 37% students walk | 42.6% two-wheeler | Rs. 785/month | Mahalanobis - 2nd Five Year Plan.

4. THREE NEW SUPREME COURT JUDGES

- **Question:** Three High Court Chief Justices elevated to the Supreme Court (announced **5 October** by the **Ministry of Law**): **Sunita Agarwal** (CJ Gujarat HC, from Allahabad HC), **Devendra Kumar** (CJ Delhi HC, from Allahabad HC), **Apresh Kumar** (CJ Telangana HC, from Jharkhand).
- **Articles:** High Court - **Art. 214**; HC judges' appointment - **Art. 217**; Supreme Court - **Art. 124**; SC judges' appointment - **Art. 124(2)**.
- **Process:** **Collegium** recommends; **President** appoints. **Oaths:** HC Chief Justice - by the **Governor**; HC judge - by the **Chief Justice of the HC**; SC judge - by the **CJI**; CJI - by the **President**.
- **SC strength: 37 judges + CJI = 38; CJI: Surya Kant** (53rd). Also: removal process of the **Chief Election Commissioner** (protest demanding Gyanesh Kumar's resignation) explained in a separate session.

QUICK REVISION: 3 HC CJs to SC: Sunita Agarwal, Devendra Kumar, Apresh Kumar | Law Ministry, 5 Oct | Art. 124(2) | Art. 214, 217 | Collegium, President | Strength 37+1 | CJI Surya Kant (53rd).

5. AL-ALAMEIN JOINT DECLARATION (RED SEA)

- **Question:** Declaration of 4 October by four countries - Egypt, Eritrea, Somalia and **Sudan** (answer: Sudan). Signed at **Al-Alamein, Egypt**.
- **What:** these four (called a 'Quad', not India-US-Australia-Japan) will manage governance of the **Red Sea** - from the **Suez Canal** to **Bab-el-Mandeb** - without a fifth country interfering. Geography: **Gulf of Aden, Sinai Peninsula** between the **Gulf of Suez** and **Gulf of Aqaba**.
- **Nile:** also in focus - a trans-boundary river between **Egypt and Sudan**; **White Nile + Blue Nile** meet in **Sudan**; delta on the **Mediterranean** near **Alexandria** (Egypt).
- **Horn of Africa** (4 countries): Somalia, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Djibouti - **Djibouti is not part** of this declaration. Also seen: Persian Gulf, **Gulf of Oman, Strait of Hormuz**.

QUICK REVISION: Al-Alamein Declaration | Egypt, Eritrea, Somalia, Sudan | 4 Oct | Red Sea: Suez to Bab-el-Mandeb | Nile: White + Blue meet in Sudan, delta near Alexandria | Not the India-US-Aus-Japan Quad.

6. DIBRUGARH TO DHAKA - INTERNATIONAL CARGO VESSEL

- **Question:** From which Assam city was an international cargo vessel sent? **Answer: Dibrugarh**. Flagged off by **Sarbananda Sonowal** (**Ministry of Ports**; ministry ambassador mentioned: Manu Bhaker). Destination: **Dhaka, Bangladesh**.
- **Vessel:** **Patkai**, carrying **methanol**. Route on the **Brahmaputra - National Waterway-2** (declared **1988**); route about **768 km** (class also gave 891 km for NW-2). **NW-1 = Ganga (1,620 km)**.
- **First such vessel since 1947** on this route (steam boats ran till about **1913**). Supported by the India-Bangladesh **Inland Water Transit and Trade Protocol, 1972**. Also mentioned: China-Afghanistan corridor started.

QUICK REVISION: Dibrugarh (Assam) to Dhaka | Sonowal, Ports Ministry | Vessel Patkai, methanol | Brahmaputra, NW-2 (1988) | ~768 km | NW-1 Ganga 1,620 km | First since 1947 | 1972 protocol.

7. N KISAN FINANCE WASH SOCIAL BOND AND SEBI 'JAGRUK' CAMPAIGN

- **Question:** First Indian company to issue a **WASH-focused social bond**? **Answer: N Kisan Finance Ltd**, supported by **NABARD** (formed **12 July 1982**); **listed on NSE**; to raise about **Rs. 180 crore**; tenure **5 years** (matures **2031**).
- **WASH** = **Water, Sanitation and Hygiene** (A = and). Social bond = money raised from investors used for social work. NSE and BSE are regulated by **SEBI**.
- **SEBI 'Jagruk Investor' awareness campaign:** tagline 'Samajh se Investing Simple' (as spoken); runs in English, Hindi and **11 languages**.

QUICK REVISION: N Kisan Finance - first WASH social bond | NSE-listed | NABARD (12 Jul 1982) | Rs. 180 cr | 5 yrs, 2031 | WASH = Water, Sanitation, Hygiene | SEBI Jagruk campaign, 11 languages.

8. INDIA-SWITZERLAND TEPA AND GIFTS

- **Question:** Which country's President received a Kashmiri walnut gift? **Answer: Switzerland** - President **Guy Parmelin** (spoken 'Gelmin') visited Delhi and met **PM Modi**.
- **Agreement: TEPA - Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement** (like an FTA) signed with Switzerland.
- **Gifts: Kutchi shawl** (Kutch, Gujarat) | **Sadeli box** (Surat, Gujarat) | **Kashmiri walnut-wood panel** (hand-drawn village scene) | **3 cheeses: Gulmarg cheese** (J&K, got an award in Brazil), **Konark cheese** (lemon-like taste, awarded) and an India-Swiss blend ('Your' as spoken) - a mountain cheese.
- **Recap Switzerland:** Europe, neutral, capital **Bern**, Alps; India wants \$100 billion investment in 5 years.

QUICK REVISION: Swiss President Guy Parmelin | TEPA signed | Gifts: Kutchi shawl, Sadeli box (Surat), Kashmiri walnut panel, Gulmarg + Konark + Swiss-Indian cheeses | Capital Bern.

9. ODISHA MICE INCENTIVE PORTAL

- **Question:** First state to launch a **MICE Incentive Portal**? **Answer: Odisha**, launched by **Deputy CM Pravati Parida**. **MICE** = **Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, Exhibitions** (also boosts business, tourism, culture, destination weddings).
- **Focus: Bhubaneswar** (international airport, 'Temple City'). Pravasi Bharatiya Divas: **2025 Bhubaneswar**; **2027 Kolkata** (9 Jan).

QUICK REVISION: Odisha - first MICE portal | Deputy CM Pravati Parida | MICE = Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, Exhibitions | Focus Bhubaneswar.

10. NATIONAL WILDLIFE WEEK AND DAYS

- **National Wildlife Week: 2-8 October**; linked to the wildlife board/authority formed in **1952**; first celebrated **1955**. Theme: '**Connecting Habitats, Thriving Wildlife**' (as spoken). **World Wildlife Day: 3 March**.
- **World Habitat Day: 5 October. International Coffee Day: 1 October**. Class clarification: Royal Bengal Tiger and other big cats are different animals.

QUICK REVISION: Wildlife Week 2-8 Oct | Board 1952, first 1955 | Theme: Connecting Habitats, Thriving Wildlife | World Wildlife Day 3 Mar | Habitat Day 5 Oct | Coffee Day 1 Oct.

11. HARMANPREET KAUR STEPS DOWN AS CAPTAIN

- **Question:** Which player gave up captaincy in all three formats? **Answer: Harmanpreet Kaur** (she has not quit cricket). New captain: **Smriti Mandhana** (earlier vice-captain).
- **Record:** captained India to Asian Games gold (2022 and recently), **Women's World Cup 2025** (India and Sri Lanka) - the **3rd Indian captain** to win a World Cup after **Kapil Dev** and **MS Dhoni**; **CWG 2022 Birmingham silver**; first player (men or women) to captain **150 T20Is**.
- **Jersey:** Harmanpreet **23** (Mumbai Indians); Smriti Mandhana **18** (RCB, WPL).

QUICK REVISION: Harmanpreet quits captaincy (all formats) | Smriti Mandhana new captain | 3rd World Cup-winning Indian captain after Kapil, Dhoni | 150 T20Is | CWG 2022 silver | Jersey 23; Smriti 18.

MCQ PRACTICE - ALL QUESTIONS FROM TODAY'S CLASS (Q1-Q57)

Options were read aloud for few questions; others are reconstructed from class discussion (answers as taught). Correct answer = bold with tick.

- Q1. Nobel Prize in Physics 2026 was won by?**
(A) Georg Nagel (B) **Francis Halzen ✓** (C) Carl Deisseroth (D) Peter Hegemann
- Q2. Francis Halzen's nationality (as taught)?**
(A) Swiss (B) **Belgian-American ✓** (C) German (D) British
- Q3. Physics Nobel 2026 work relates to?**
(A) Higgs boson (B) **Neutrinos (IceCube) ✓** (C) Quantum computing (D) Black holes
- Q4. IceCube Observatory is located at?**
(A) Himalayas (B) Greenland (C) **South Pole ✓** (D) North Pole
- Q5. Neutrino is also called the?**
(A) Light particle (B) God particle (C) **Ghost particle ✓** (D) Dark particle
- Q6. Nobel Physics is awarded by?**
(A) UNESCO (B) **Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences ✓** (C) Nobel Committee (Norway) (D) Karolinska Institute
- Q7. Asiatic Society of Bengal (1784) is linked to?**
(A) Cornwallis (B) Curzon (C) **Warren Hastings ✓** (D) Dalhousie
- Q8. Tehri Dam is on which river?**
(A) **Bhagirathi ✓** (B) Sharda (C) Alaknanda (D) Yamuna
- Q9. Cost-push inflation is caused by?**
(A) **Rise in input costs ✓** (B) Fall in supply of money (C) Fall in taxes (D) Rise in demand
- Q10. Angle of contact of a non-wetting liquid on glass is?**
(A) **Obtuse ✓** (B) Zero (C) Right (D) Acute
- Q11. SEBI came into existence in 1988; statutory status in?**
(A) **1992 ✓** (B) 2000 (C) 1991 (D) 1995
- Q12. India's first National Household Travel Survey was released by?**
(A) ICMR (B) RBI (C) NITI Aayog (D) **NSO ✓**
- Q13. Father of Indian Statistics?**
(A) Amartya Sen (B) **P.C. Mahalanobis ✓** (C) V.K.R.V. Rao (D) C.R. Rao
- Q14. Mahalanobis model is linked to which Five Year Plan?**
(A) **Second ✓** (B) First (C) Third (D) Fifth
- Q15. Percentage of men who travel (survey as stated)?**
(A) 71.9% (B) **61.9% ✓** (C) 41.9% (D) 51.9%
- Q16. How many Supreme Court judges were appointed (CJs elevated) recently?**
(A) **3 ✓** (B) 5 (C) 4 (D) 2
- Q17. Article for appointment of Supreme Court judges?**
(A) **124(2) ✓** (B) 148 (C) 217 (D) 214
- Q18. Article for appointment of High Court judges?**
(A) **217 ✓** (B) 214 (C) 226 (D) 124
- Q19. Who administers oath to a High Court Chief Justice?**
(A) CJI (B) President (C) **Governor ✓** (D) Chief Minister
- Q20. Who administers oath to a Supreme Court judge?**
(A) Law Minister (B) **CJI ✓** (C) Vice-President (D) President
- Q21. Who administers oath to the Chief Justice of India?**
(A) **President ✓** (B) Speaker (C) PM (D) Vice-President
- Q22. Present CJI (53rd)?**
(A) D.Y. Chandrachud (B) Sanjiv Khanna (C) **Surya Kant ✓** (D) B.R. Gavai
- Q23. Number of Supreme Court judges (including CJI)?**
(A) 35 (B) **38 ✓** (C) 34 (D) 40
- Q24. Al-Alamein Declaration countries: Egypt, Eritrea, Somalia and?**
(A) Ethiopia (B) Djibouti (C) **Sudan ✓** (D) Libya
- Q25. Al-Alamein Declaration concerns which sea?**
(A) **Red Sea ✓** (B) Arabian Sea (C) Mediterranean (D) Black Sea
- Q26. Where do the White Nile and Blue Nile meet?**
(A) Uganda (B) Egypt (C) **Sudan ✓** (D) Ethiopia
- Q27. Nile delta lies near which Egyptian city?**
(A) Aswan (B) **Alexandria ✓** (C) Cairo (D) Luxor
- Q28. Which Horn of Africa country is not part of the declaration (as taught)?**
(A) Somalia (B) **Djibouti ✓** (C) Sudan (D) Eritrea
- Q29. International cargo vessel sailed from which Assam city?**
(A) **Dibrugarh ✓** (B) Tezpur (C) Silchar (D) Guwahati
- Q30. Dibrugarh vessel destination?**
(A) Kathmandu (B) **Dhaka ✓** (C) Kolkata (D) Chattogram
- Q31. Name of the vessel?**
(A) Majuli (B) Kaziranga (C) Brahma (D) **Patkai ✓**
- Q32. National Waterway-2 is on which river?**
(A) Godavari (B) **Brahmaputra ✓** (C) Barak (D) Ganga
- Q33. National Waterway-1 length?**
(A) 2,000 km (B) **1,620 km ✓** (C) 768 km (D) 891 km
- Q34. Who flagged off the vessel (Ministry of Ports)?**
(A) Jyotiraditya Scindia (B) Himanta Sarma (C) **Sarbananda Sonowal ✓** (D) Nitin Gadkari
- Q35. First WASH-focused social bond was issued by?**
(A) SBI (B) **N Kisan Finance Ltd ✓** (C) HDFC (D) NABARD
- Q36. WASH stands for?**
(A) Welfare, Sanitation and Health (B) **Water, Sanitation and Hygiene ✓** (C) Water, Soap and Health (D) Water, Safety and Hygiene
- Q37. NABARD was formed in?**
(A) 1991 (B) 1969 (C) 1975 (D) **1982 ✓**
- Q38. SEBI's awareness campaign name?**
(A) Smart Investor (B) Nivesh Mitra (C) Sahi Nivesh (D) **Jagruk Investor ✓**
- Q39. Swiss President who visited India?**
(A) Alain Berset (B) **Guy Parmelin ✓** (C) Viola Amherd (D) Ignazio Cassis
- Q40. India-Switzerland agreement abbreviation?**
(A) **TEPA ✓** (B) CEPA (C) CECA (D) FTA-Plus
- Q41. Sadeli box (gift) is from?**
(A) Ahmedabad (B) Kutch (C) Rajkot (D) **Surat ✓**
- Q42. Kutchi shawl (gift) is from?**
(A) Assam (B) Kashmir (C) **Kutch, Gujarat ✓** (D) Punjab
- Q43. Which cheese is from Gulmarg?**
(A) Konark cheese (B) Paneer (C) **Gulmarg cheese ✓** (D) Mozzarella
- Q44. First state to launch MICE incentive portal?**
(A) Goa (B) Gujarat (C) **Odisha ✓** (D) Kerala
- Q45. MICE stands for?**
(A) None (B) **Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, Exhibitions ✓** (C) Meetings, Industry, Culture, Events (D) Markets, Investment, Commerce, Economy
- Q46. Who launched Odisha's MICE portal?**
(A) Dharmendra Pradhan (B) **Pravati Parida ✓** (C) Mohan Majhi (D) Naveen Patnaik
- Q47. National Wildlife Week is observed on?**
(A) 2-8 November (B) **2-8 October ✓** (C) 1-7 October (D) 15-21 October
- Q48. World Wildlife Day is on?**
(A) 5 June (B) 3 October (C) **3 March ✓** (D) 22 May
- Q49. World Habitat Day?**
(A) 2 October (B) 1 October (C) **5 October ✓** (D) 8 October
- Q50. International Coffee Day?**
(A) 29 September (B) 5 October (C) **1 October ✓** (D) 10 October
- Q51. Which player gave up captaincy in all formats?**
(A) Mithali Raj (B) **Harmanpreet Kaur ✓** (C) Smriti Mandhana (D) Deepti Sharma
- Q52. New India women's captain?**
(A) Jemimah Rodrigues (B) Shafali Verma (C) Richa Ghosh (D) **Smriti Mandhana ✓**
- Q53. Harmanpreet Kaur's jersey number?**
(A) 10 (B) 18 (C) **23 ✓** (D) 7
- Q54. Smriti Mandhana's jersey number?**
(A) **18 ✓** (B) 23 (C) 7 (D) 77
- Q55. Harmanpreet is the _ captain to win a World Cup for India?**
(A) 5th (B) 2nd (C) **3rd ✓** (D) 4th
- Q56. Number of T20Is captained by Harmanpreet (first to reach)?**
(A) 100 (B) 125 (C) **150 ✓** (D) 175
- Q57. Vice President of India?**
(A) Venkaiah Naidu (B) Jagdeep Dhankhar (C) Hamid Ansari (D) **C.P. Radhakrishnan ✓**

ANNOUNCEMENTS

- Homework: answer the class question in the comment section. West Bengal PSC paper shared on Telegram (Sunday). From next **Monday**: one monument/GK topic revised with AI images (or a 5-10 minute separate video). Watch the separate session on the protest and the **CEC removal process**.
- SSC CHSL Target Batch** crash course (3 months, code **KRITI10**); teacher's classes start **12 October**. 11:00 AM class is on; class PDF on **Telegram**.